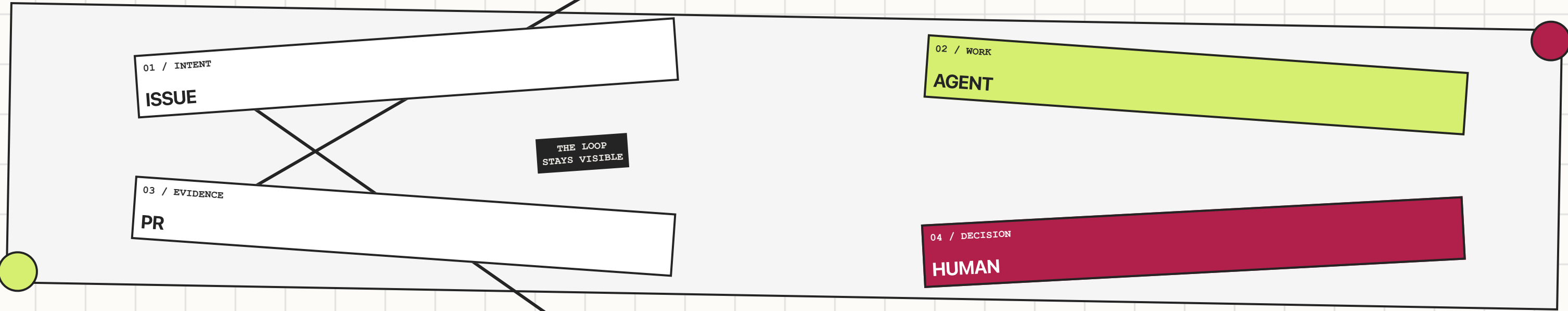


A NEW WAY TO BUILD TOGETHER

The repository is the room.

Parallel development with agents needs a shared place to propose work, show evidence, and make decisions.

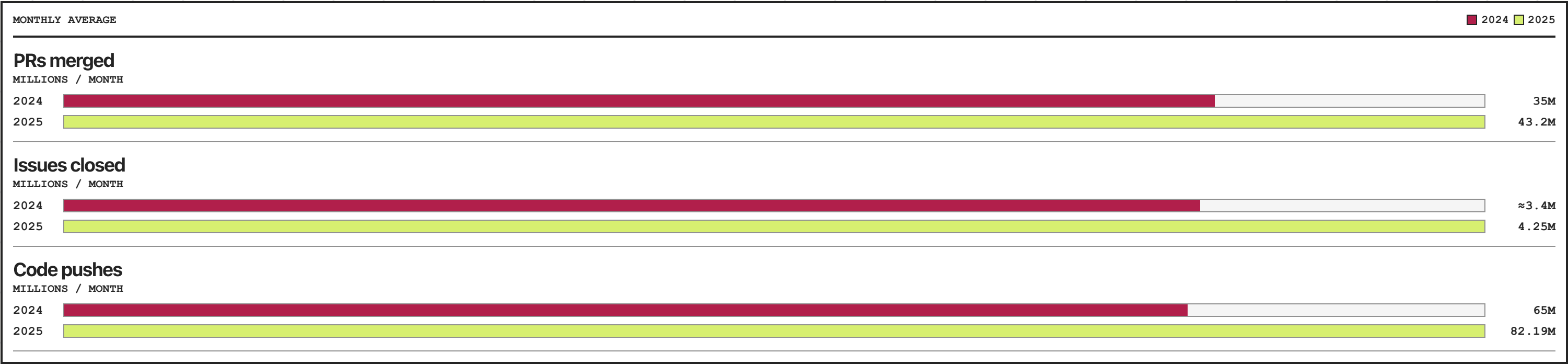
JM Julia Muiruri
Developer Experiences (DX) at GitHub



GITHUB OCTOVERSE 2025

More work reaches the review surface.

Across three different measures, the monthly average rose year over year.



The scale of 2026.



AUG 2026

≈130M

PRs merged per month

≈24M

New repositories per month

The PR and repository estimates are visual readings near the August 2026 endpoints of GitHub's published charts.

GITHUB ACTIONS

Automation has its own scale.

Public and open-source projects used 11.5B Actions minutes in 2025, up 35% from 2024.



PLATFORM-WIDE / DAILY JOBS

71M jobs per day

Reported in GitHub's Actions update. A daily job count, not the annual public/open-source minutes charted here.

Following the August outage, GitHub pivots its reliability work to focus on adding capacity, improving efficiency, and removing architectural bottlenecks

[SOURCE / GITHUB RELIABILITY UPDATE ↗](#)

BOTH SIDES ARE RIGHT

Two needs. One platform.



DEVELOPERS WANT

More leverage

Agents that can investigate, make a start, and carry work across tools.

LESS FRICTION / MORE CAPABILITY



MAINTAINERS NEED

More control

Clear boundaries for intake, automation, review, and the final call.

CLEARER SIGNAL / ACCOUNTABLE DECISIONS

Speed is not the goal. Trustworthy flow is.

Make the path from intent to decision legible to everyone in it.



Dimensions of parallelization

Decide where work runs, when it starts, and who remains accountable.

01 / WHERE

Environment

Keep close work local; give independent changes their own workspace.

02 / WHEN

Timing

Work now, on a defined event, or on a deliberate schedule.

03 / WHO

Ownership

Developer, agent, or focused subagents; a person owns the decision.

Choose the surface for the work.

Match the task to the right degree of direct control, coordination, and isolation.

DIRECT / 01

At the keyboard

VS Code
Copilot CLI

Keep a focused edit and its checks close to your local workspace.



COORDINATE / 02

Across sessions

Copilot app
agent sessions

Follow parallel lanes; bring their results together for review.



DELEGATE / 03

Beyond the laptop

Cloud agents
tasks

Use isolated cloud execution for bounded work when it fits.

IDEs: VS Code

Start with project context. Inspect the agent's work before it becomes yours.

01 / TASK CONTEXT

Set the boundary.

Give the goal, repository guidance, and a checkable finish line.

HUMAN INPUT

02 / AGENT EDITS

VS CODE WORKSPACE

TARGET FILE

setup.md

PROPOSAL

A focused change

Stay in the editor while the agent explores and proposes edits.

03 / EVIDENCE

Read the result.

- unclear step
- + checkable step

Diff + test outcome; note what remains uncertain.

04 / HUMAN REVIEW

Keep, revise, or reject.

THE DECISION STAYS WITH YOU

GitHub Copilot CLI

Direct a bounded task at the terminal, then check what actually changed.

TERMINAL / LOCAL WORKSPACE

HUMAN + AGENT

01 / INSPECT

Find the context.

Read the files and repository instructions.

02 / DIRECT

Name one change.

Set scope and a checkable result.

03 / VERIFY

Check the work.

Run focused commands or tests; inspect the diff.

EVIDENCE TO CARRY FORWARD

What can you show?

CHANGESFiles and diff

CHECKSCommands and outcomes

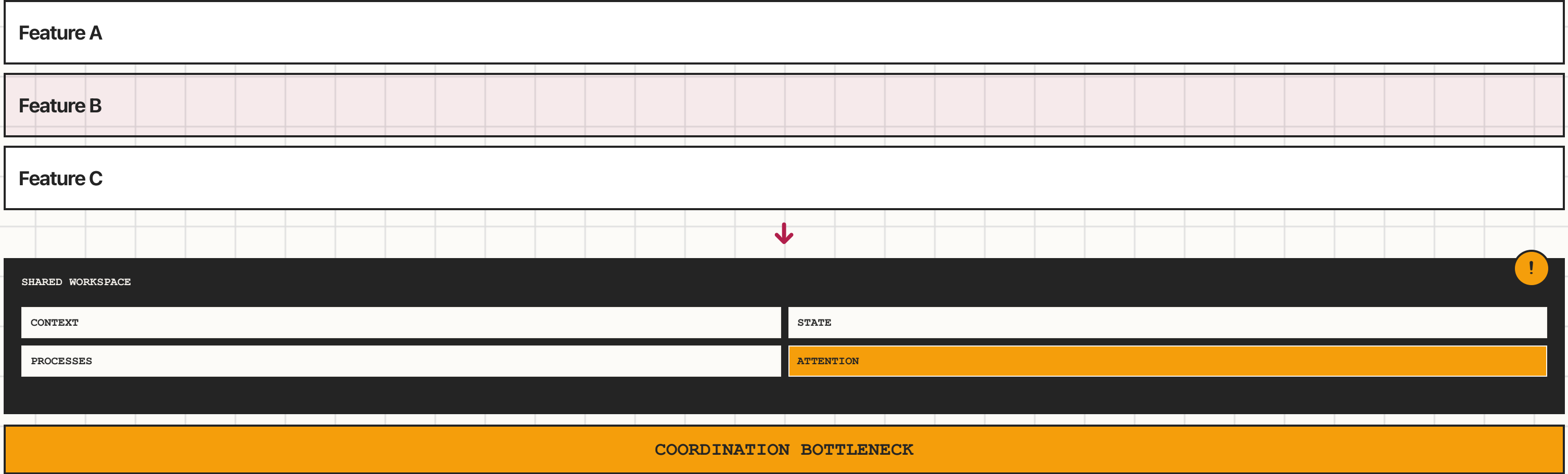
GAPSWhat remains uncertain

04 / HUMAN REVIEW

Make the call.

Keep or revise after reading the evidence.

Parallel work needs coordination.



GITHUB COPILOT APP

Agent-native developer tools

Coordinate parallel agent work. See where attention is needed; keep the review and decision with a person.

gh.io/app

PARALLEL WORK / SHARED VIEW

Feature A

Add search functionality

Feature B

Migrate the database to PostgreSQL

Feature C

Fix checkout validation

HUMAN REVIEW

Decide what moves forward.

A SHARED CONTRACT

Give the work a visible path.

Parallel lanes meet again when issues frame the work and PRs carry its evidence.

01 / FRAME

Issue

What needs to change and why?

HUMAN-DEFINED INTENT

02 / EXPLORE

Agent

What approach might work?

BOUNDED EXECUTION

03 / SHOW

Pull request

What changed, and what supports it?

REVIEWABLE EVIDENCE

04 / GOVERN

Maintainer

Is this ready to merge?

HUMAN DECISION

PULL REQUESTS

Put the handoff in the PR.

The PR is where generated work becomes reviewable work.

PROPOSED CHANGE

READY FOR REVIEW

Make first-run setup reproducible

- Unclear prerequisite

+ Explicit environment check

+ Verified preview step

AUTHOR: AGENT-ASSISTED

DECISION: MAINTAINER

01

Scope

Does the change match the issue?

02

Evidence

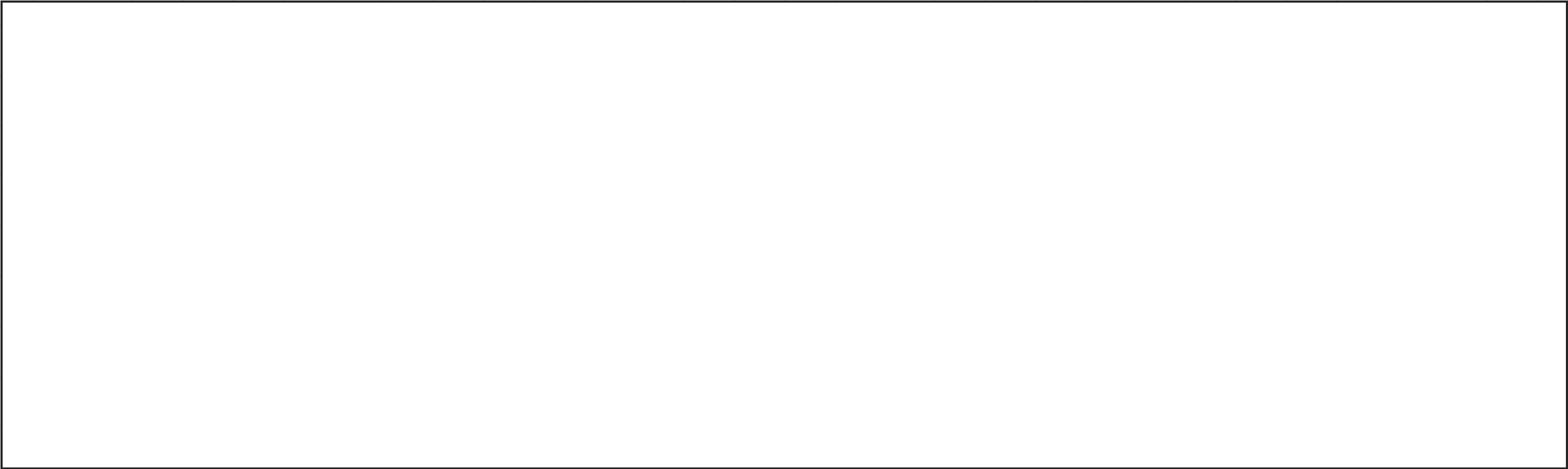
Do the checks support the claim?

03

Judgment

Are the tradeoffs acceptable?

A report enters triage.



SWIPE IMAGE TO READ

The report gets a record.

Issue details on GitHub. Confirmation back in Slack.



THE HUMAN + AGENT FUTURE

Build the loop you can trust.

People set intent. Agents work in isolated lanes.
Maintainers decide with evidence.

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